

13. Business Impact

The figures below are **illustrative estimates** calculated from this dataset under stated assumptions. They show the scale of potential benefit and are not forecasts.

Scenario	Assumption	Estimated effect
Reduce the top two issues (Managing an account; Other transaction problem)	10% fewer complaints	About 14,700 fewer complaints (2.5% of 596,121)
Bring student-loan timely response to about 98%	Raise 71.3% to 98.0%	About 10,500 fewer late responses; overall timely rate rises from 96.9% to roughly 98.7%
Raise mortgage relief to the vehicle-loan level	4.6% to 8.8% on 53,242 complaints	About 2,200 more customers receiving relief
Detect surges early	Alert at 3 times normal volume	Faster separation of campaign-driven spikes from real failures, avoiding misreading roughly 61,000 extra complaints in one month

Qualitative impact: lower regulatory and reputational risk, lower handling cost per complaint, better customer trust, and faster decisions because leaders see the same numbers on one page.

Method note: late-response estimates use percentages rounded to one decimal place, so treat them as approximate.

14. Conclusion and Future Scope

Conclusion

Across 596,121 complaints from October 2024 to August 2026, three product groups (cards, bank accounts and digital payments) hold 77.5% of complaints, and three everyday issues (account management, transaction problems and card-statement disputes) make up 32.3%. Overall response quality is high at 96.9% timely, but **student loans stand out sharply for late responses (71.3% timely) and relief is rare outside cards and accounts.**

The January 2025 spike shows why raw counts can mislead: two companies and one issue made up most of that month, and public reporting ties it to enforcement news and social media activity. Reporting with and without such spikes, and normalising by customer base, is essential for fair decisions.

The project also shows careful data handling. Duplicates caused by the API's inclusive date range were removed, and the incomplete latest month was excluded after daily counts proved it was under-reported.

Future scope

1. **Text analytics** on complaint narratives (for consenting consumers) with topic modelling and sentiment.
2. **Forecasting** monthly volume, with January 2025 handled as an event.
3. **Predictive models** that classify which complaints are likely to receive relief or a late response, using `relief_flag` and `timely_flag` as targets.
4. **More products**, including credit reporting and debt collection as a separate analysis.
5. **An India comparison** against RBI Ombudsman annual-report statistics.
6. **Vulnerable-consumer analysis** using the Older American and Servicemember tags.